



Laura St. George
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My Love of the Pointe

I came to the Pointe in 1978 to look at property, and as I stood on Lot 27 above the Lagoon, I fell in love! I purchased the lot and built my “enchanted dwelling” shortly thereafter. For the next 20 years, I was a weekender and vacationer. Hartstene became a retreat from my busy work life. I was nurtured by the glorious morning sunrises across the lagoon, the many water birds, the eagles and the osprey. Early on summer mornings, I was awakened by the seagulls and other early birds announcing another magnificent day at the Pointe.

In 1999, after retiring from teaching, I made this my permanent residence, and the sights I was blessed with during visits became daily gifts. I have seen Mergansers, including one mother with three little ones clinging to her back. She was persuading them and pushing them onto the dock to bask in the sun. One morning I counted seven different species of ducks together in the lagoon: wood ducks, buffleheads, goldeneyes, pintails, scaups, mallards, and occasional Canadian geese. Hovering overhead or perched as sentrys in the surrounding trees, eagles and osprey looked on, patiently waiting for breakfast. Though hard to accept as nature’s way, I watched an eagle drop down, grab one of the beautiful ducks and fly off. I’ve observed eagles diving for a fish and flying into a nearby tree to devour its treat. These are not once-in-a-lifetime sights, they’re regular occurrences. On a rare occasion, I watched an eagle grab a small otter in the lagoon, and drag it up on the bank. Herons, still and watchful, are daily visitors. I see all of this from my window, while sitting on the sofa.



Seals also show up in the lagoon occasionally. One day a large seal took up residence on the dock, back and forth, for several days. Upon my approaching it for a good photograph, I got a loud “tongue-lashing” before it slid off into the water.

On the trails and in my yard, many deer and fawns graze. I’ve had eye contact with a coyote, and even a bobcat in my driveway. They were off in a flash, but not before I was able to see their beauty. While walking the trail, enjoying the gorgeous view of the water, Mt. Rainier and the Olympics, I often come face-to-face with deer and raccoon. Many birds occupy the trees around.

To date, my most unforgettable experience was witnessing a doe giving birth to a fawn about 20 yards away from my deck. She dropped the newborn, cleaned it up, got rid of the afterbirth, and nurtured the little one. Finally, she was able to nudge it up on its legs, wobbly and unsteady. It was a touching, personal experience.

The Pointe has become a favorite gathering place of friends and family who love the beauty of the lagoon, mountains, forest and the ever constant sea.

On clear nights when I crawl into my bed which faces the window, I am soothed by the moon rising and spreading its reflection across the water and into the lagoon. Another wonderful day at the Pointe ends with all of the joy and hope of waking up to a new gift-bearing day.

